

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - October 8, 2026

Compiled summary for Thursday, October 8, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the October 7 responsive UI/UX Philosophy and 3D carousel record; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying all fifty pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs; consolidating the philosophy into seven decisions; separating number, title, and card rows; rebuilding the navigation triangles and ornate key emblem; expanding the desktop scene from three to five visible stacks; stabilizing bidirectional Motion navigation through explicit coordinates and transform layers; widening the active stack while reducing and layering its internal content; refining perspective, opacity, hover, border, and clipping behavior; removing the intermediate two-column variant; rewriting the Leadership, Sustainability, and Collaboration beliefs; building an interactive rotating Core Beliefs orbit with upright text; correcting the star image pivot and canvas edge treatment; adding exclusive hover emphasis and viewport-centered portrait emphasis; validating routes, TypeScript, responsive breakpoints, motion states, and local cache behavior; documenting commits 4e1a45a, 29a8c4c, 6a3e0ce, and ac963f4; refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot; and generating the October 8 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, grouped work-completed sections, committed-source sequence, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact covers Portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_october7.pdf` and documentation commit 902b456. The application work is represented by four October 8 commits on main, matching origin/main at ac963f4 before this documentation pass. No application-source edit, commit, push, manual Hostinger synchronization, or production-release action was performed while generating this PDF. The documentation deltas are the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` file and this root-level October 8 worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date through an independent UTC-04:00 time query, which reported October 8, 2026 at 10:41:25 PM. The filename and title therefore use Thursday, October 8 rather than an execution-host or UTC date.
- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before composing this record. The refreshed snapshot contains 18,356 lines and 610,065 bytes of source, configuration, asset inventory, Git state, PDF inventory, and workflow context.
- Extracted all fifty pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with `pdftotext` and inspected their metadata with `pdftinfo`. The archive before this artifact contained 288 PDF pages and 141,637 extracted words, spanning July 11 through October 7 with same-day Part suffixes where required.
- Compared every worklog title and section sequence. The mature convention remains a month-name filename with a non-zero-padded day, a dated title, a dense opening synthesis, reviewed sources, prior baseline, goals, grouped technical work, validation, files touched, follow-up continuity, and an output-artifact close.
- Used October 7 as the direct chronological baseline because it documented the eight-entry responsive philosophy system, its earlier one-, two-, and three-column states, the first three-stack Motion scene, and the accepted hero/proof-stat context. Used September 15 for the original Core Beliefs formation and October 5 for the most recent belief-copy and landing-section framing.
- Inspected representative early, middle, and latest PDFs visually and reviewed full-archive metadata. The mature output remains unencrypted US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, compact black-on-white technical prose, Codex metadata, and a repeated dated page footer.
- Reviewed commits 4e1a45a, 29a8c4c, 6a3e0ce, and ac963f4 with `git log`, `git show`, commit bodies, file statistics, and final source. The range after the October 7 documentation commit added `CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx` and changed `UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx`, `page.tsx`, `aboutdev/page.tsx`, `globals.css`, and the generated snapshot.
- Reviewed the live implementations in `app/CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx`, `app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx`, `app/page.tsx`, `app/aboutdev/page.tsx`, and `app/globals.css`, plus the `beliefs-star4.png` raster properties and the current local routes.

Baseline Status Before October 8 Work

- The October 7 state presented eight philosophy decisions through a responsive carousel. Desktop showed three stacks, tablet used an intermediate two-column layout, slim portrait used one column, and the active content remained comparatively narrow inside the section.
- Desktop navigation still depended on layout projection and role transforms that could produce uneven rightward motion, stutter, clipping, or gap drift while stacks changed roles. The scene did not yet expose outer-left and outer-right stacks simultaneously.
- Number controls and title headers shared earlier top-row geometry. The external arrows were functional but had not yet reached the final rounded triangular silhouette, placement, scale, spacing, synchronized border

response, or relationship to the active number.

- No key emblem sat above the active selector. The section still contained decision 08, older header language, and the previous subtitle rather than the seven-key framing accepted later in the day.
- The active large card retained full-size internal copy, device media, and background numerals. Expanding its width risked clipping or overlap because foreground layers had not been independently scaled and positioned.
- My Core Beliefs remained a static five-bubble star composition on the landing page. The About Developer page held related static cards, and the shared belief language still used Inter-connectivity, User-friendliness, the Einstein quotation, and the earlier collaboration sentence.

Goals for October 8

- Reduce the philosophy to seven deliberate keys, improve its heading language, and make number, title, arrow, and key controls read as one coherent hierarchy.
- Expand the desktop carousel to five visible stacks while keeping one perfectly forward-facing center stack, two inner perspective stacks, and two stronger outer perspective stacks without clipping or directional asymmetry.
- Preserve smooth navigation as cards change width and role, keep inactive stacks subdued but inspectable, and unify active/hover borders across selectors, arrows, titles, cards, and the key.
- Let the active stack use more desktop width while scaling its internal assets independently, protecting layer order and maintaining text, image, device-frame, and background-number separation.
- Remove the intermediate two-column philosophy variant so widths through 980px use the existing narrow single-column presentation and desktop begins at 981px.
- Turn Core Beliefs into an interactive formation that rotates the selected bubble to the top by the shortest route, keeps all text upright, protects the star glow, and provides exclusive hover and portrait emphasis without reordering portrait content.

Work Completed - Seven-Key Controls and Section Language

- Removed decision 08 and retained the ordered seven-key sequence: Modern, Appealing, Smooth, User-friendly, Responsive, Cohesive, and Adaptable. Selector values remain 01 through 07, while the large card backgrounds use their simplified significant digits.
- Moved every number box into its own row above the associated title panel and centered it horizontally. Title panels continue across the stack width while number controls remain distinct square anchors.
- Refined header typography relative to the number size, restored zero-prefixed selector labels after a temporary hash experiment, renamed the second key Appealing, and retained User-friendly for decision 04.
- Updated the section subtitle to 7 Keys to Lock In the User With Immaculate Design, preserving the established UI / UX Philosophy heading and landing-section treatment.
- Redesigning the previous/next controls as large rounded triangular surfaces inspired by the supplied references. Successive passes smoothed the full silhouette, moderated the tip, retained the base shape, increased size, and matched their gaps to the stacked row rhythm.
- Created a custom horizontal SVG key with the crown to the left and teeth downward. Its shaft was shortened, its head remained unclipped, its fill reused the triangle gradient language, and its size and vertical spacing were normalized above the active number.
- Kept the key stationary during navigation so the seven-card content moves beneath a stable symbolic control. The key received a fixed active border and later joined the shared border-only hover state without changing its fill or shadow.

Work Completed - Five-Stack Desktop Perspective

- Expanded the desktop scene from three to five simultaneous stacks: previous outer, previous inner, active, next inner, and next outer. Only the center remains front-facing; inner stacks rotate approximately 36 degrees and outer stacks approximately 49 degrees.
- Separated Motion responsibilities into three layers. The cell animates explicit x/y coordinates, a positioner animates active versus inactive width, and the stack owns opacity, scale, z-depth, origin, and rotateY. This removed the earlier right-navigation jerk caused by width reflow and 3D interpolation competing on one element.
- Replaced responsive grid redistribution with symmetric role coordinates. The accepted desktop centers use roughly plus or minus 521.1px for inner roles and plus or minus 750.5px for outer roles, with the active role at zero and outer roles lowered by 16px.
- Preserved spring navigation at stiffness 180, damping 24, and mass 0.85. Explicit positions let left and right navigation settle through equivalent paths instead of allowing one direction to lunge toward the viewer.
- Tuned inactive transforms through repeated visual checks. Inner roles retain scaleX 0.87318 and scaleY

0.7938; outer roles retain scaleX 0.78, scaleY 0.65, and z -80. The final outer height is deliberately larger than an earlier 0.615 experiment while remaining shorter than the inner stack.

- Balanced outer-to-inner gaps at approximately 13px and active-to-inner gaps at approximately 26.5px in the measured desktop state. Moving outer coordinates with the inner adjustment preserved the previously accepted outer spacing rather than reopening a large side gap.
- Normalized inactive opacity to 25 percent at rest and 50 percent on mouse hover or touch emphasis. Earlier outer-only 12/25 percent rules were discarded so all four inactive stacks now share a consistent visibility system.
- Matched inactive stack borders to the active stack resting border while allowing opacity to control hierarchy. Hover brightening remains local and does not violate the reduced-opacity rule.
- Added overflow clipping at the section boundary to contain the expanded five-stack track without changing the carousel itself as the viewport narrows before the official responsive snap.

Work Completed - Active Stack Width, Layers, and Hover Feedback

- Expanded only the active stack width while inactive stack widths remain fixed. A card grows smoothly as it becomes active and contracts as it leaves, preserving the five-in-view logic rather than scaling the whole carousel.
- Reduced active large-card internal assets to half scale, including descriptive copy, screenshots, phone/tablet frames, project labels, and decorative numerals. The large background number remains behind every foreground asset.
- Rebuilt vertical placement inside the active card: copy begins near 40px, device content begins near 290px, and foreground layers use explicit z-order so text, media, and attribution do not clip or bleed into one another.
- Shortened excessive top space in large number cards, tightened internal vertical intervals, and kept the large card at a stable desktop height while the overall active stack became wider.
- Matched active stack borders to the active case-study card language. Hovering any active stack region brightens number, title, content card, both triangle outlines, and the key outline to the same `rgba(230,255,239,0.78)` state.
- Made triangle emphasis shared: hovering either triangle brightens both navigation controls plus the number and active stack borders. The resting triangle state remains the established `rgba(198,255,217,0.36)` active-border treatment.
- Added a dedicated SVG flood class for the key outline. Only flood color and opacity change during group hover; the key gradient, fill, and shadow remain unchanged, satisfying the border-only emphasis requirement.
- Kept inactive-stack whole-card click capture, project-link protection, arrow hold behavior, keyboard controls, and reduced-motion handling from the prior system.

Work Completed - Responsive Philosophy Simplification

- Removed the 631-to-980px two-column state from component state, visible-offset selection, strip templates, column templates, and card-height rules. `compactColumnCount` is now a 1-or-3 state rather than 1-or-2-or-3.
- Widths at or below 980px render the established one-column flat selector/card presentation. Widths at 981px and above render the five-stack desktop perspective scene.
- Preserved the narrow layout content, controls, project media, and navigation behavior rather than creating a new tablet-only structure. The change reduces intermediate reflow and keeps the desktop composition untouched until the breakpoint.
- Recorded a future option to rasterize finalized versions of the seven stack interiors if responsive text and image assets cannot preserve the exact approved perspective appearance across unusual display scaling. The current implementation intentionally remains editable HTML/CSS/React.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Copy and Interactive Orbit

- Renamed Inter-connectivity to Sustainability and replaced its sentence with A product that does not hold up over time, simply is not a viable product. Applied the same change to the landing and About Developer data.
- Renamed User-friendliness to Leadership and replaced the Einstein quotation with Making the difficult decisions is not always fun -- but it is always necessary. Applied the same change to both pages.
- Replaced the landing Collaboration sentence with A team is never stronger than its weakest link while preserving the existing five-tone visual order: Vision, Integrity, Sustainability, Leadership, and Collaboration.
- Extracted the landing formation into the new client-side `CoreBeliefsOrbit` component. It owns active desktop selection, cumulative rotation, portrait emphasis, element references, accessible labels, and the star image. The About Developer formation remains structurally static while sharing the revised copy.
- Made every non-top circular bubble a button. Clicking a right-side bubble rotates the orbit

counterclockwise; clicking a left-side bubble rotates clockwise. The selected bubble travels only one or two 72-degree star points, the shortest route, before reaching the top.

- Counter-rotated the inner text layer by the exact inverse cumulative angle. Bubbles, borders, gradients, shadows, and the star rotate together while every title and sentence remains horizontal and readable during and after motion.
- Scaled non-top bubbles to 85 percent and composited them at 50 percent opacity, affecting text, surface gradient, border, outer ring, and shadow as one object. The top bubble remains full size and full opacity.
- Added exclusive desktop hover emphasis. A hovered inactive bubble temporarily becomes full size and full opacity while the current top bubble simultaneously adopts the 85/50 inactive state. Leaving restores the top bubble, and hovering never changes orbit order or rotation.
- Disabled the current top button and supplied aria-pressed plus descriptive labels for top, rotate-to-top, emphasized, and emphasize actions. Reduced-motion preference removes transition duration without removing state communication.

Work Completed - Star Pivot, Edge Treatment, and Portrait Beliefs

- Diagnosed star drift as a raster-canvas problem rather than an orbit-coordinate problem. beliefs-star4.png is 2012 x 1956 RGBA, but all pixels have nonzero alpha, roughly 80 percent are fully opaque, and corner pixels are near-black rather than truly transparent.
- Moved the star image transform origin to 50 percent / 57.45 percent. At the rendered desktop size the origin measured 300.305px by 335.445px and aligned with the formation center within approximately 0.36px, eliminating horizontal and vertical orbit drift.
- Retained mix-blend-mode screen so the star keeps its established glow. Added a radial WebKit and standard mask that stays fully opaque through 88 percent of the image and feathers only the outermost 12 percent, preventing a faint rectangular canvas from surfacing on displays with different gamma, HDR, or blend behavior.
- Left the star outward opacity gradient and each bubble inward gradient intact. The edge mask does not threshold, flatten, or recolor the star artwork; it only softens the extreme raster boundary beyond the visible star.
- Kept portrait bubbles in their original one-column DOM order, removed star/orbit transforms in that layout, and increased the vertical gap before settling at a responsive 36px to 66px range.
- Added requestAnimationFrame-based scroll measurement for the stacked layout. The bubble closest to the viewport vertical center becomes the single full-size/full-opacity belief while all others remain at 85 percent and 50 percent.
- Portrait taps can emphasize a bubble without rotating, reordering, or moving it. Desktop and portrait active indices remain separate so crossing a media condition does not corrupt the accepted desktop orbit.

Work Completed - Local Preview, Cache, and Documentation Continuity

- Maintained the Next.js preview at 127.0.0.1:3000 throughout the carousel and belief work, using installed Google Chrome through Playwright for geometry, transform, hover, and breakpoint checks.
- Encountered repeated Turbopack cases where source CSS changed but the running browser retained an older generated stylesheet. Each stale instance was diagnosed through computed styles or stylesheet-rule inspection, the listening process was terminated, .next was moved to recoverable temporary storage, and one clean server was restarted.
- Verified border-only key hover after cache refresh by reading SVG flood color and opacity before and during active-group and direct-key hover. The fill filter remained unchanged.
- Regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt after the four October 8 application commits. The snapshot is the only tracked working-tree modification before creation of this PDF.

Committed Source Sequence

- 4e1a45a - Refined the UI/UX Philosophy Carousel and Interaction System. Reworked number/header/control layout, rounded triangle feedback, ornate key treatment, inactive opacity, seven-key data, subtitle language, and snapshot context.
- 29a8c4c - Expanded and refined the UI/UX philosophy carousel. Added five visible desktop stacks, stronger outer perspective, responsive alignment, smoother navigation layers, tighter section spacing, and a regenerated snapshot.
- 6a3e0ce - Refined the UI/UX philosophy carousel experience. Stabilized symmetric coordinates and width animation, widened and relayed the active stack, tuned outer geometry, unified borders, and finalized User-friendly plus Lock In copy.
- ac963f4 - Refined responsive philosophy and Core Beliefs experiences. Removed two-column philosophy mode, added CoreBeliefsOrbit, introduced exclusive emphasis and portrait viewport selection, revised belief

language across routes, and committed the final October 8 application state.

- Together the four commits move from control-level philosophy polish, through a five-stack scene rebuild, into stable active-card layering, and finally into responsive simplification plus a complete interactive beliefs system.

Validation Summary

- Ran npm run check after the final source state; TypeScript completed successfully with no emitted files.
- Confirmed /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles each returned HTTP 200 from the refreshed local server.
- Validated UI/UX breakpoints with Playwright after waiting for client layout effects: 1440 x 1100 and 981 x 900 resolved to data-column-count 3 with exactly five 3D stacks; 980 x 900 and 390 x 844 resolved to data-column-count 1 with one flat card and no 3D stack.
- Measured the accepted desktop five-stack gaps at approximately 13.24px outer-to-inner and 26.5px inner-to-active on both sides. Left/right transforms and positions remained symmetric.
- Verified Core Beliefs desktop hover yields exactly one full-size/full-opacity bubble: the hovered bubble reports scale 1 and opacity 1 while the former top and remaining bubbles report scale 0.85 and opacity 0.5.
- Clicked the first right-side belief and confirmed a shortest-path -72deg orbit rotation, active index 1, counter-rotated text, and a stationary corrected star pivot.
- Centered the third portrait belief at approximately y=421.5 in a 390 x 844 viewport and confirmed it alone reported full opacity; the other four remained at 0.5 opacity and 0.85 scale. DOM title order remained unchanged.
- Emulated prefers-reduced-motion: reduce during state checks and confirmed transitions collapse to zero duration while final emphasis and responsive states remain correct.
- Ran git diff --check after the final edits and found no whitespace errors. main and origin/main both resolved to ac963f41b0dfd75e1552fd2bc318e101b707245e before snapshot and PDF generation.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx - added the client-side belief orbit, shortest-path directional math, inverse text rotation, accessible button states, responsive layout detection, and viewport-centered portrait selection.
- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - reduced responsive modes to one or three columns, expanded desktop rendering to five roles, separated cell/width/3D animation, added explicit geometry, refined active content scaling, and integrated key-border behavior.
- app/page.tsx - reduced philosophy data to seven decisions, revised titles and subtitle, updated landing belief language, and replaced static landing belief markup with CoreBeliefsOrbit.
- app/aboutdev/page.tsx - synchronized Sustainability and Leadership titles and statements with the accepted Core Beliefs language.
- app/globals.css - implemented five-stack scene geometry, active-card layering, shared border states, key outline transitions, responsive philosophy collapse, orbit animation, exclusive belief emphasis, corrected star pivot/mask, and portrait spacing.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated through ./read_project.sh to capture commit ac963f4, current sources, assets, configuration, Git state, and all fifty earlier root-level worklogs.
- portfolio_worklog_october8.pdf - created as the first October 8 Portfolio worklog at the repository root using the established no-Part filename.

Follow-Up Context

- Desktop UI/UX mode begins at 981px and contains exactly five stacks. Widths at or below 980px intentionally skip a two-column state and render the single-column flat version.
- The five desktop role coordinates, widths, transform origins, and scale values are tightly coupled. Change geometry symmetrically and remeasure both gap pairs after any adjustment.
- The active stack alone grows wide. Its copy, number, device, imagery, and project label are independently scaled to 0.5 and explicitly layered; removing those rules can recreate clipping or foreground overlap.
- The key and arrows are fixed controls outside the moving stack transform. Key hover is border-only through the SVG flood class; do not replace it with whole-key brightness unless the visual requirement changes.
- The current philosophy contains seven decisions and no 08 stack. Selectors use zero-prefixed labels, large card backgrounds use significant digits, and the subtitle uses the Lock In seven-key framing.
- The editable React/CSS stack interiors may still respond subtly to unusual font rasterization or display scaling. If perfect perspective fidelity becomes more important than editability, generate raster versions of all seven finalized stack interiors and retain semantic controls outside those images.
- CoreBeliefsOrbit relies on five evenly ordered principles and 72-degree steps. Reordering or changing the

- count requires checking shortest-path math, CSS placement, and the counter-rotation behavior.
- The star PNG is not truly transparent. Preserve the corrected 50 percent / 57.45 percent pivot, screen blend, and outer 12 percent feather unless the asset is replaced with a genuinely transparent export.
- Portrait belief emphasis is determined by distance from the viewport center. It intentionally changes visibility without rotating, reordering, or moving the stacked bubbles.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for a commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly requests those operations.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october8.pdf as the latest daily worklog for Thursday, October 8, 2026, following the established month-name, non-zero-padded day, and no-Part first-record naming convention.
- Produced an unencrypted US Letter, PDF 1.4 document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, mature section ordering, repeated dated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: ac963f41b0dfd75e1552fd2bc318e101b707245e on main and origin/main before snapshot and PDF generation.
- No application-source change, source commit, push, manual deployment, Hostinger synchronization, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.